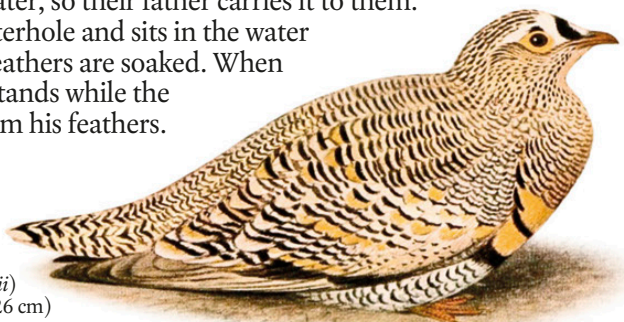


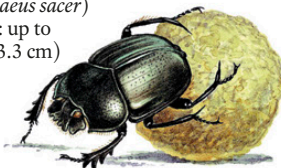
Flying water carrier

Sandgrouse need to drink water every day. Chicks cannot fly off to find water, so their father carries it to them. He flies to a waterhole and sits in the water until his belly feathers are soaked. When he returns, he stands while the chicks drink from his feathers.

Lichtenstein's sandgrouse
(*Pterocles lichtensteinii*)
Length: up to 10 in (26 cm)

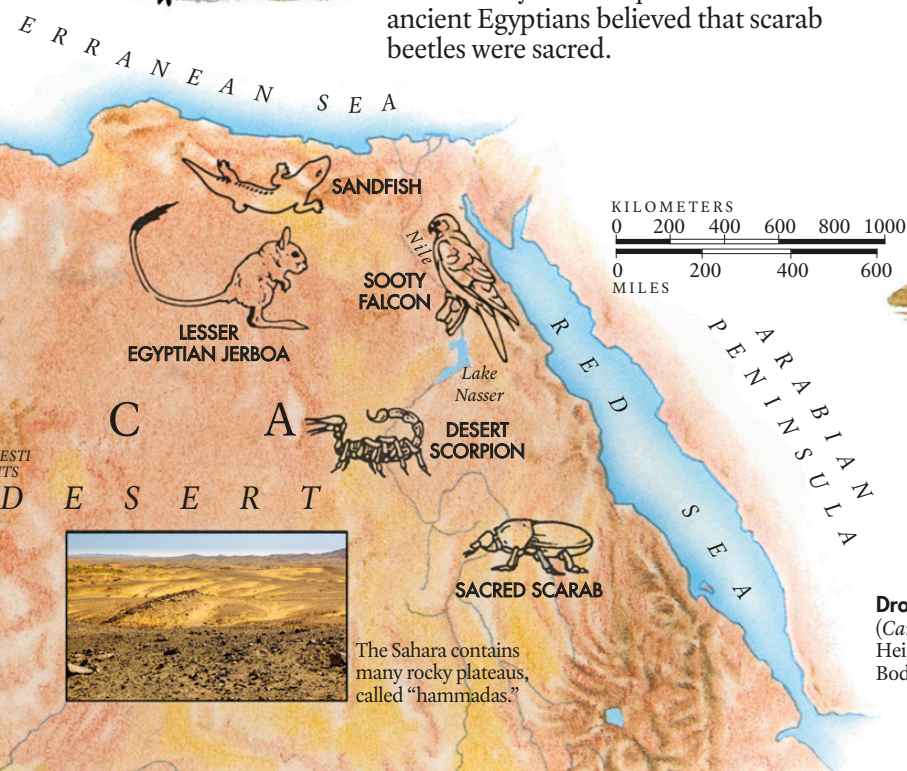


Sacred scarab
(*Scarabaeus sacer*)
Length: up to 1.3 in (3.3 cm)



Dung roller

The scarab eats the dung of other desert animals, rolling it into balls and burying it in holes to feed its young. It has a shiny exoskeleton, which reflects the Sun's rays and keeps it cool. The ancient Egyptians believed that scarab beetles were sacred.



The Sahara contains many rocky plateaus, called "hammadas."



Dromedary camel
(*Camelus dromedarius*)
Height at shoulder: up to 6 ft 6 in (2 m)
Body length: up to 11 ft (3.4 m)

Storage hump

A dromedary (Arabian camel) can go without water for a few weeks. Made up mostly of fat, its hump provides energy when food and water are scarce. The camel's long, thick eyelashes protect its eyes, and it can close its nostrils to keep out sand.

Addax
(*Addax nasomaculatus*)
Height at shoulder: up to 3 ft 9 in (1.15 m)
Horns: up to 3 ft 3 in (1 m)



Rare addax

Many addax have been killed for their skins, so they are now very rare. The addax never drinks—it gets moisture from eating plants. Its wide hooves allow it to travel quickly and easily over soft sand.

Fierce falcon

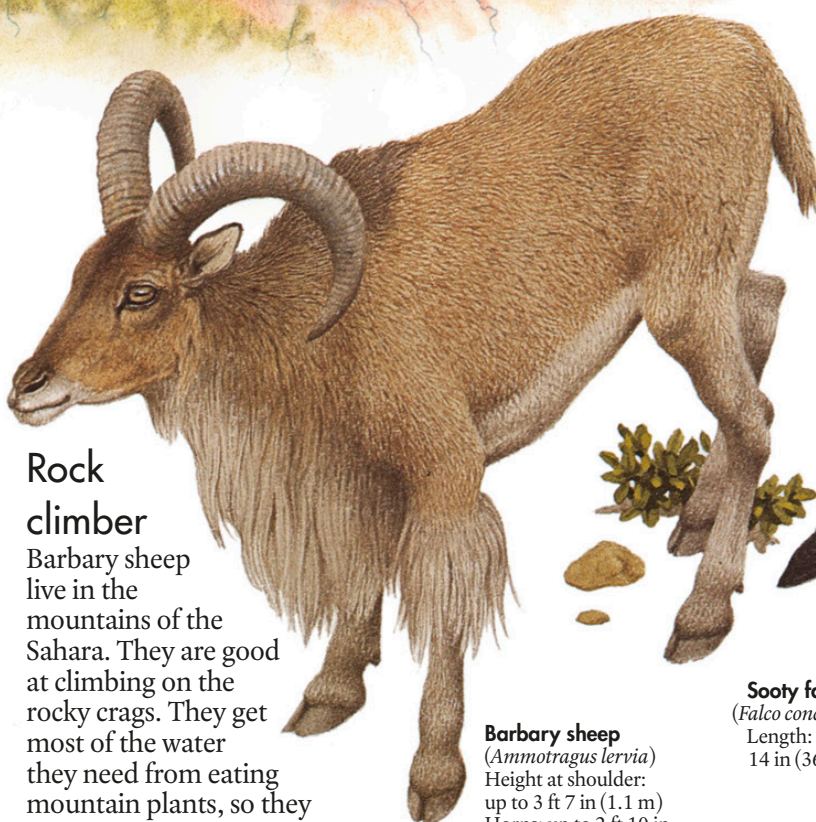
Sooty falcon chicks hatch in late summer, when many small birds migrate across the Sahara. Adult falcons catch migrating birds that stop to rest and feed them to their chicks.



Sooty falcon
(*Falco concolor*)
Length: up to 14 in (36 cm)

Rock climber

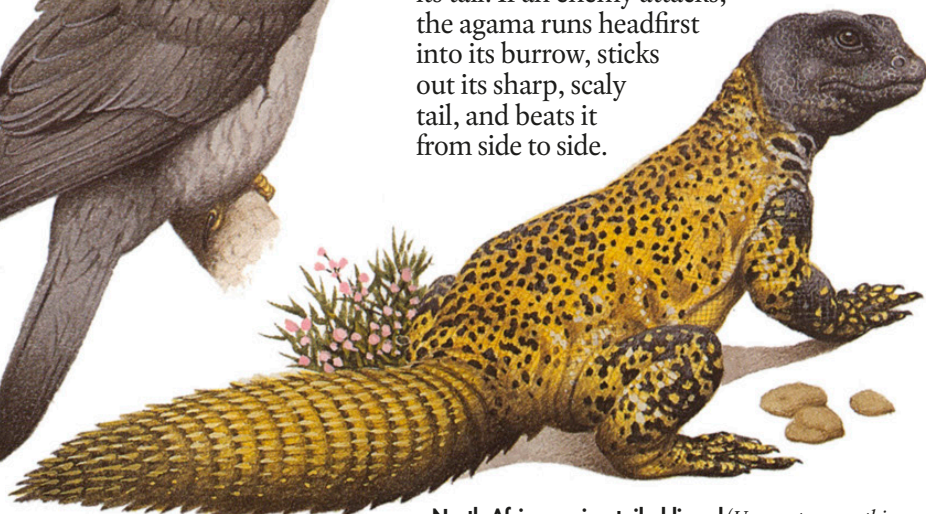
Barbary sheep live in the mountains of the Sahara. They are good at climbing on the rocky crags. They get most of the water they need from eating mountain plants, so they rarely need to drink.



Barbary sheep
(*Ammotragus lervia*)
Height at shoulder: up to 3 ft 7 in (1.1 m)
Horns: up to 2 ft 10 in (88 cm)

Fat tail

If food is scarce, the spiny-tailed lizard can survive up to a month on the fat stored in its tail. If an enemy attacks, the agama runs headfirst into its burrow, sticks out its sharp, scaly tail, and beats it from side to side.



North African spiny-tailed lizard (*Uromastyx acanthinura*)
Length including tail: up to 17 in (43 cm)